Your grade: 100%

Your latest: **100%** • Your highest: **100%** • We keep your highest score.

Next item →

Instructions

An Angry Dog

Take a moment and imagine that you are running in the park on a sunny, warm spring day. The calm you are experiencing is interrupted by some low growling sounds. You spin around and, to your horror, you see a big, angry-looking dog running toward you, teeth bared! In the following interactive, "An Angry Dog," you will be asked to consider your thoughts, feelings, and actions as they relate to encountering the angry dog.

1. **When you see a dog bearing down on you, what will you be thinking, feeling, and doing in response to this event?** 1 / 1 point

1. Thoughts (What's going through your mind?)
"Oh no, that dog is going to attack me!"

"I need to get away fast!"

"Should I run, or will that make it worse?"

"I wish I had something to defend myself."

"Why didn't I see this coming sooner?"

"If I stay calm, maybe it will lose interest."

Theme: Immediate threat assessment, survival instincts, and rapid decision-making.

2. Feelings (What emotions arise?)
Fear — overwhelming sense of danger

Anxiety — racing heart, feeling unsafe

Panic — urge to react immediately

Anger — frustration at being in this situation

Vulnerability — feeling exposed and helpless

Theme: Intense emotional arousal triggered by the fight-or-flight response.

3. Actions (What do you do?)
Freeze — stand still, hoping the dog loses interest

Back away slowly — avoid sudden movements

Run — if there's a safe distance or barrier nearby

Use a barrier — hold up a backpack or jacket as a shield

Shout — yell loudly to try to scare the dog off

Call for help — shout for someone nearby to assist

Theme: Physical actions driven by survival instincts and quick situational judgment.

Final Takeaway
This exercise shows how thoughts (interpreting the threat), feelings (emotional response), and actions (behavioral reactions) are all interconnected in real-time. In AI design, this is similar to how agents process inputs, evaluate risks, and take actions—mirroring human decision-making under pressure.

Feedback

You may be thinking, "The dog looks angry," "I'm scared," and "I'd better run." Perhaps less obviously, you are probably experiencing physical arousal: Your heart is pounding in your chest, you begin to sweat, and your breathing becomes more rapid. As you can see from this example, anxiety and fear have cognitive, emotional, behavioral, and physical components. What do you think, feel, and do when you feel anxious or fearful? How does your body respond?